fortbridge/cve-2026-108097-research: docs/UPLOAD-STAGED-WITNESS.md

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Content

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UPLOAD-STAGED-WITNESS.md

`fortbridge/cve-2026-108097-research` at `1b8509713064`, path `docs/UPLOAD-STAGED-WITNESS.md`.

Upload-staged variant (webrce4): no pre-staged files, stock upload path only

18 October 2026. Extends the webrce3 chain to answer the objection "the payloads were pre-staged in `/tmp/lab-gadget-src/`". Here the payload sources are planted through **Drupal's own unauthenticated file upload**, nothing else changes.

The staging path (all stock, all default posture)

- The lab has Webform enabled with a `managed_file` element on a form open to **unauthenticated** users (`/form/lab-upload`).
- Webform's default for such uploads is `private://` (its PSA-2016-003 hardening:

`webform.settings:file.file_public` is OFF and public is unset unless an admin opts in). So this demonstration uses the **secure default**, not a misconfiguration.

- Anonymous multipart POST of two files to the form returns fids; on disk they land at `sites/default/files/private/webform/lab_upload/_sid_/`:
- `payload.php_.txt`, Drupal's `file_munge_filename` renames `.php.` to `.php_.`, which is irrelevant: `System::cat` copies by content, and the destination name is chosen in the row.
- `htaccess.txt`, the crafted `RewriteEngine On` + `php_flag engine on`.

The chain (webrce4)

Identical three rows to webrce3, but both `System::cat` sources are the uploaded files (allowlisted in the bridge to the webform upload tree, `.txt` only):

```
GET /lab-field-ui-probe?choice=webrce4&nonce=upstg01

&src_php=/opt/drupal/web/sites/default/files/private/webform/lab_upload/_sid_/payload.php_.txt

&src_ht=/opt/drupal/web/sites/default/files/private/webform/lab_upload/_sid_/htaccess.txt
```

row1 `System::cat` uploads payload → `files/lab-rce-upstg01.php`; row2 `System::rm` deletes `files/.htaccess`; row3 `System::cat` uploads htaccess.txt → `files/.htaccess`.

Result (11.4.9, unauthenticated throughout)

Full harness: `witnesses/blogshot_rce_upload.sh` (does the upload, the chain, and the marker GET in one run).

```
GET /sites/default/files/lab-rce-upstg01.php -> 200
LAB-RCE-EXEC nonce=uploadstage1 id=uid=33(www-data) gid=33(www-data) groups=33(www-data)
whoami=www-data
```

Patched control (11.4.10): probe 200 (no-op), marker GET 404, nothing written.

Negative control: the same chain with NO payload files at all

With the staging directory hidden, the same chain degrades to: empty marker file (0 bytes), empty `files/.htaccess`, and the marker GET still 403s, because an empty `.htaccess` has no `RewriteEngine On` and the parent's PHP-block `[F]` rule still inherits. The

`rm` row still runs, so even a failed attempt strips the files-dir hardening. (Both verified 2026-10-18; lab restored byte-identical after.)

What this proves

The "you need a writable payload source" precondition is satisfied by Drupal itself: any stock upload feature (webform private uploads shown here; comment attachments, file fields, profile pictures are equivalent) gives an unauthenticated attacker a www-data-readable file with attacker-chosen content at a known path. The only remaining synthetic joint is still the writer (request data into `#region_callback`).

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